Music Video Generator

User Manual

On first start the program automatically creates all required subfolders (clips/, intro/, outro/, pre-intro/, photos/, output/, cache/). You do not have to create them beforehand.

Important before the first render: the program ships without video clips. After the folders have been created on first start, you must fill clips/traurig/ (sad), clips/neutral/, clips/gluecklich/ (happy) and clips/animations/ with your own video material. Pre-intro, intro and outro videos can optionally be placed in their folders.

First start: language

On the very first start the program asks for the language (Deutsch, English, Español). The choice is stored in the file mvg_settings.json next to the program. You can change it later via the help menu '?' (restart the program afterwards).

Help in the program

The '?' button opens a menu with four entries: Click help, Quick guide, PDF manual and Language. With click help you click any button, switch or area and get it explained in detail; while you hover, a blue bar at the top shows the name of the area. After one explanation click help ends by itself - for the next one simply choose it again in the '?' menu (Esc or End cancels it earlier). It works in the main window and in the clip editor.

Folder structure

The following subfolders are created automatically in the program folder on first start:

Folder	Content
clips/traurig/	Video clips - sad mood (fill yourself)
clips/neutral/	Video clips - neutral mood (fill yourself)
clips/gluecklich/	Video clips - happy mood (fill yourself)
clips/animations/	Animation clips (fill yourself)
pre-intro/	Pre-intro video(s) with their own sound - picked at random (optional)
intro/	Intro video(s) - picked at random (optional)
outro/	Outro video(s) - picked at random (optional)
photos/	External photos (optional)
output/	Finished videos are saved here (shorts from URL in output/Shorts)
cache/normalized/	Normalization cache - managed automatically

cache/segments/	Segment cache for the clip editor - automatic
ffmpeg/	FFmpeg - do not touch (must be provided manually)
Sound/	Done sound - do not touch (must be provided manually)

Supported formats: video: .mp4 .mov .mkv .avi .webm | images: .jpg .jpeg .png .webp | audio: .mp3 .wav

Step by step

1. Load music

Click Choose music and select an MP3 or WAV file. The program analyzes the file automatically and detects the beat. The output file name is generated from the music title.

2. Choose format

Option	Description
Normal 16:9	Standard landscape - for YouTube etc. (default: on)
Normal 9:16	Portrait - full music length
Short 9:16 - 58s	Portrait - 58 s with soft fade in and out (picture and sound) - for Reels, Shorts, TikTok (default: on)

Several formats can be selected (at least one must stay active). By default a 16:9 video and a 58-second short are created in one go. File names: Title.mp4, Title_9x16.mp4 and Title_Short.mp4. The short uses the strongest part of the song (usually the chorus) and is always created without pre-intro, intro, outro and title. With several formats rendering takes correspondingly longer. The clip editor edits the first selected format (normally the 16:9 video).

3. Choose cutting speed

Option	Description
Gentle	Cuts about every 3.5 seconds - very calm, atmospheric
Slow	Cuts about every 2.2 seconds - calmer, cinematic style
Normal	Cuts about every 1.7 seconds - balanced (default)
Fast	Cuts about every 0.95 seconds - energetic, dynamic
Random	Every cut random between 0.95 and 3.5 seconds

All cuts are automatically placed on the beat of the music.

Internal clip pool

The internal clip pool uses clips from the mood folders. The pool switch must be on.

Option	Description
Automatic	All available clips of the selected mood are used
10 / 20 / 30 Clips	Random selection of the given number from the pool
Manual selection	A thumbnail window opens - pick clips with a click

Choose mood: Sad / Neutral / Happy / Animation - multiple selection possible. Without a selection all folders are used.

Manual selection: the thumbnail window shows all clips of the chosen mood. Click to select (blue frame = active). OK becomes active as soon as at least one clip is chosen.

Sources and options

Switches:

Switch	Function
Pre-intro	Put a video from the pre-intro/ folder in front (with its own sound, before the music) - default: off
Intro	Show an intro video from the intro/ folder (silent, under the music)
Outro	Append an outro video from the outro/ folder (with its own sound, after the music)
Title	Music title at the bottom left of the video (Arial Bold) - starts after the intro; never in the 58 s short
Internal pool	Use clips from the mood folders
External clips	Use clips from an external folder
External photos	Use photos from an external folder

Folder buttons:

Button	Function
Short from URL	Use the YouTube link from the clipboard (see below)
Choose external clips	Select an external video folder
Choose external photos	Select an external photo folder

Source modes

Mode	Description
Internal only	Only clips from the mood folders
External only	Only external clips or photos - repeated when needed
Mix	External clips are preferred (70%), internal ones fill up

Render process

When you click Render the following happens automatically:

1. Pre-intro is prepared (if on) - with its own sound, before the music
2. Music is analyzed, beats are detected (for the short: strongest section)
3. Intro is prepared (if on)
4. Clips and photos are muted and scaled to the target format
5. Cuts are placed randomly on the beat
6. Audio is mixed (for the short with soft fade in and out)
7. Title overlay is shown (if on) - starts after the intro
8. Outro is appended (if on) - with its own sound, after the music
9. The finished video is saved in the output/ folder

The progress bar and status line show the current state. A sound signals the finished render.

Short from URL

The button 'Short from URL' (in the Sources & options area) turns a YouTube video into a 45-second portrait 9:16 short with the original sound, soft fade in and out and an automatically chosen strongest section. Copy the video link to the clipboard and click the button. The short is saved in the folder output/Shorts. The first time, a small extra component (Deno) is downloaded automatically - an internet connection is required. The video must be at least 45 seconds long. Please only use videos you have the rights to.

Clip editor

After rendering the button 'Edit clips' becomes active - right next to the Render button. A click opens the clip editor; the window transforms and all settings are kept. Here you can reorder or replace clips without re-rendering the whole video.

Layout:

At the top left are the 'Cancel' button and a hint. Reset and help are in their usual place at the top right. Most of the window is the clip grid - all used segments as thumbnails, including pre-intro, intro and outro. At the bottom are the Apply button, the status line with progress bar and the buttons to play the video, upload to YouTube and open the output folder.

Removing clips:

If a clip does not fit, click '✕ Remove' on its tile. The clip is replaced by another random clip of exactly the same length, so the video stays exactly as long as the song. Clips that do not yet appear in the video are preferred. Pre-intro, intro and outro cannot be removed. 'Cancel' restores all replaced clips, 'Apply' rewrites the video. The new order is kept when you reopen the editor.

Reordering clips by drag & drop:

Click a clip and hold the mouse button. A floating blue label follows the pointer. Move over the target clip - it lights up blue. Release the button to swap the two clips. The 'Apply' button becomes active as soon as at least one change was made. While applying, the status line and progress bar show the current step.

The outro is fixed at the end (golden frame, lock symbol), the pre-intro at the start (violet frame, lock symbol) - neither can be moved. This guarantees that pre-intro, music and outro sound play cleanly one after another.

Button	Function
Apply	Only re-runs the joining step - very fast
Cancel / Back	Back to the main window (everything is reset before applying)
Watch video	Open the finished video in the external player
YouTube	Opens the YouTube upload page in the browser
Output folder	Open the output folder in Explorer
Reset	Reset all settings - optionally clear the cache

A hint appears when you close the program in editor mode.

Buttons in the main window

Button	Function
Render	Start rendering
Edit clips	Open the clip editor (active after rendering)
Watch video	Open the last rendered video directly

YouTube	Opens the YouTube upload page in the browser
?	Help menu: click help, quick guide, PDF, language
Output folder	Open the output folder in Explorer
Reset	Reset all settings - optionally clear the cache

Open the PDF manual via the '?' menu; it opens if it is in the program folder (in your language).

Tips

→ *Fill the clip folders first - the more material, the more varied the result*

→ *Put several intros, outros or pre-intro clips in the folders - the program picks one at random when rendering*

→ *Mix mode is great for combining project-specific material with standard clips*

→ *The 58 s short is ready for Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts and TikTok*

→ *The title is generated from the music file name - special characters are cleaned up*

→ *The cache speeds up repeated renders - if space is short, clear it via Reset*

→ *Put animation clips in clips/animations/ and select them with the mood checkbox*

→ *Random cutting is good for experimental or energetic videos*

→ *In the clip editor you can reorder several times and then click Apply*

→ *When reordering, the outro always stays at the end and the pre-intro at the start - so no sound gets lost*

→ *The pre-intro is off by default and must be enabled with its switch*

→ *The YouTube button saves the detour through browser and channel search*